

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 5

♥ Q J

♦ A K 9

♣ J 9 6 4 2

♠ A 8 3

♥ A K 6 4

♦ Q 5 2

♣ Q 8 7



♠ K 9 6

♥ 7 5 2

♦ 10 4

♣ A K 10 5 3

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ 10 9 8 3

♦ J 8 7 6 3

♣ -

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

North opens 1NT.

Your first thought should be that with only 4 points you will pass. But on second thought, what would partner respond if you bid a Stayman 2♣? So you give it a shot and partner says 2♥. What next?

What's next is your PASS. And if he had bid 2♠ you also would have passed. And if he had bid 2♦ you also would have passed. You figured that with this hand any response partner could make would be a better place than 1NT.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 8 5

♥ K 6 4

♦ Q J 7

♣ K 10 8

♠ 10 9 6

♥ J 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ J 9 7 5 4



♠ A K 7 3

♥ A 9 5

♦ 9 8 2

♣ A Q 2

♠ 4 2

♥ Q 10 8 7 3

♦ A 10 6 3

♣ 6 3

East opens 1NT.

With 12 points and a 4-card ♠ suit this fits the model for Stayman.

But thinking a little further, with this 4-3-3-3 distribution you have no ruffing values whatsoever. So even if partner also has 4 ♠s there might not be an advantage in playing the suit contract. So for this specific distribution you ignore your 4-card Major and just bid 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

**Board 5**

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 3  
♥ 9 8 6 5 3  
♦ K 8 6 2  
♣ 6 3 2

♠ A Q 10 6

♥ Q 7

♦ 10 9 5

♣ K 9 7 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K J 7 5 4 2

♥ A 10 2

♦ 4 3

♣ Q J

♠ 9 8

♥ K J 4

♦ A Q J 7

♣ A 10 8 5

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       | Pass | 1NT   |
| Pass         | 2♣    | 2♠   | Pass  |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

After you open 1NT partner bids 2♣, then East says 2♠. What do you say next?

Basically you said your say when you opened 1NT. You don't have a 4-card Major and you have a minimum hand. The best way to convey this information to partner is to pass. At which point partner jumps to 3NT.

Pass, then "Thank you partner" when dummy comes down. The thing to remember is that partner is in charge. You describe your hand as well as you can and then sit back and let him make the decisions. Perhaps you would have doubled if you held his hand but he didn't.